

doc-regeneration-monergistic

Affirms · Soteriology › Regeneration · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: medium

Statement under examination

Regeneration (the new birth) is a monergistic work of the Holy Spirit, sovereignly imparting spiritual life to those dead in sin; logically prior to and the cause of saving faith.

Rationale

Apparatus and interlinear: John 1:13 piles three explicit denials of human-origin (ouk ex haimatōn, oude ek thelēmatos sarkos, oude ek thelēmatos andros) before the affirmation 'all' ek theou egennēthēsan (G1080 aorist passive indicative). 'Will of man' is named and excluded as origin of the new birth. John 3:3, 5, 6, 8 use gennaō G1080 in aorist passive subjunctive and perfect passive participle ('born from above / of the Spirit'), placing the person as recipient and the Spirit as agent; v.8 figures the Spirit's sovereign initiative under the wind-blows-where-it-wishes simile. John 6:44 (oudeis dynatai elthein pros me ean mē ho patēr...helkysē auton, helkō G1670 aorist active subjunctive) and 6:65 (oudeis dynatai elthein pros me ean mē ē dedomenon autō ek tou patros, didōmi G1325 perfect passive participle) state an absolute necessity: no one can come without prior divine giving. Eph 2:1, 5 predicate nekros G3498 ('dead') of the unregenerate and then make God the subject of suzōopoieō G4806 ('made us alive together with Christ'); dead persons do not cooperate in their own resurrection. Titus 3:5 negates ex ergōn en dikaiosynē and grounds salvation in his mercy dia loutrou palingenesias kai anakainōseōs pneumatōs hagiou (G3824 plus G342 plus G4151). 1 Pet 1:3 makes God the Father the active subject of anagennaō G313 ('having begotten us again'). Acts 16:14 has the Lord (kyrios) as grammatical subject of dianoigō G1272 ('opened') Lydia's heart prosechein, the heart-opening logically prior to her attentive faith. Concordance pattern: in every NT occurrence where new-birth verbs (gennaō ek theou, anagennaō, palingenesia, suzōopoieō) carry a divine subject, the human is grammatical patient; in the same network John 1:13 explicitly denies human-will as cause; the lone instrumental exception (1 Cor 4:15) is Paul speaking of pastoral begetting through the gospel, not the originating cause. Hermeneutic: redemptive-historical reading of Ezek 36:26-27 (YHWH first-person verbs natan H5414 'I will give', sur H5493 'I will remove') as the OT promise whose NT fulfillment is the Spirit-wrought new birth. The lexical-grammatical pattern supports monergistic regeneration on the narrow proposition that the new birth itself is God's sole work and logically prior to saving faith.

Reasoning

Verdict: the Bible does present the new birth as God's act upon a person, with the person on the receiving side of the verb, and as the cause that makes saving faith possible rather than the effect that follows it. The strongest reasons from Scripture. John 1:13 says that those who become children of God 'were born, not of blood nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God.' That sentence stacks three denials of human cause before naming God as the cause. John 3 says, 'Unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God,' and 'The wind blows where it wishes, and you hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it goes. So it is with everyone who is born of the Spirit.' Jesus places the Spirit in the position of the wind that goes where it pleases, and the person in the position of one who hears the sound but does not control the source. John 6:44 and 6:65 say 'no one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him' and 'no one can come to me unless it is granted him by the Father.' Ephesians 2 says we were 'dead in trespasses and sins' and that 'God, being rich in mercy, made us alive together with Christ.' Dead people do not raise themselves. Titus 3 says God 'saved us, not because of works done by us in righteousness, but according to his own mercy, by the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit.' Acts 16 says of Lydia that 'the Lord opened her heart to pay

attention to what was said by Paul.' The Lord opens, she then attends. The strongest counterarguments from inside the Bible. Revelation 3:20 has Jesus standing at the door and knocking, with the hearer opening from inside. First Timothy 2:4 says God 'desires all people to be saved.' Second Peter 3:9 says he is 'not wishing that any should perish, but that all should reach repentance.' Acts 17:30 says God 'commands all people everywhere to repent.' Matthew 23:37 has Jesus saying, 'How often would I have gathered your children together... and you were not willing.' These passages name a real human responsibility, a real divine call to all, and a real refusal that humans can offer. How the verdict handles the tension. The reading offered above says human responsibility is real, but the capacity to respond rightly is itself the Spirit's gift. The dead person does not cooperate in being raised; the now-alive person, raised by the Spirit, then believes. Honest acknowledgment: the system that puts regeneration logically before faith and makes it the cause of faith is one historic Christian reading, not the only one. Christians have disagreed on this for fifteen hundred years.

Denominational landscape

Christians agree that the Spirit regenerates, and they disagree about whether the human will, having been touched by grace, can resist or must yield. The Reformed tradition (Westminster Confession chapter 10, Canons of Dort heads 3 and 4) teaches that regeneration is the sole work of God in the elect and precedes saving faith as its cause; the human will is renewed before it believes and cannot finally resist. The Lutheran Formula of Concord (Solid Declaration Article 2) is monergistic on conversion, calling it the work of the Holy Spirit alone, but Lutherans reject double predestination and hold that humans can resist grace and fall away. Roman Catholic teaching (Catechism 1996 through 2005) calls grace the free, undeserved gift of God and at the same time requires the free human response: God's initiative demands man's free response. Eastern Orthodoxy makes synergy, the cooperation of divine grace with human freedom, a central distinctive; the Spirit gives life and the person freely receives, throughout salvation. Classical Anglicanism (Article 10) teaches that humans cannot turn to God by their own natural strength, but only when prevented and assisted by the grace of God working in them. Methodism, in the Wesleyan tradition (Articles of Religion 8), teaches the same prevenient grace: God's grace goes before, enables a good will, and works with the will once it is good. Classical Pentecostal and Anabaptist traditions are broadly Wesleyan-Arminian on this point. The patristic situation is mixed: Augustine's late anti-Pelagian writings move toward strong monergism on the initiative of grace; many earlier and Eastern fathers (Chrysostom, John of Damascus, the desert tradition) are synergistic. The Council of Orange in 529 affirmed prevenient grace against semi-Pelagianism but did not endorse strict double predestination. Public-record carriers of denial of regenerating grace altogether (treating salvation as moral effort or human achievement) are Pelagius and his theological heirs, classical liberal-modernist reductions of conversion to psychological self-improvement, and some moralistic-therapeutic-deistic strands inside modern evangelicalism. Strict denial of regeneration as God's act is rare; the in-house dispute is over whether the regenerated human will can finally resist.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	No
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	Yes
Would serve if otherwise	Yes
Would be member if otherwise	Yes

Would let children be taught otherwise	Yes
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	No

Notes

This is the central in-house Reformed-versus-Catholic-Lutheran-Wesleyan-Orthodox dispute over the ORDO SALUTIS. It is NOT the same question as 'is the Spirit the agent of regeneration' (handled by doc-spirit-regeneration), which every lineage affirms. This question asks the narrower thing: is regeneration the sole, prior work of God in the elect, the CAUSE rather than the EFFECT of saving faith. Apparatus and interlinear give a strong reading for the monergistic side on the narrow proposition (the new birth is God's act, the human is patient, the dead do not cooperate in their resurrection). But the wider ordo-salutis package that the stem evokes (Reformed unconditional election, irresistible grace, the elect alone are regenerated) is a SYSTEM not directly identical to the lexical claim, and historic Christianity disagrees in good faith on the system: Wesleyan-Arminians affirm Spirit-wrought regenerating grace but call it PREVENIENT (universally enabling and resistible); Catholic doctrine (CCC 1996-2005, 2001-2002) teaches grace as prior gift PLUS human free response; Eastern Orthodoxy makes synergeia the central distinctive; Lutheran Formula of Concord II is monergistic on conversion as God's sole work but rejects strict reprobation and double-predestination; classical Anglicanism (Article 10) holds prevenient grace as necessary and enabling. None of these positions denies that the Spirit gives the new birth; they differ on whether the human will, having been awakened by prevenient grace, resists or yields. The Bible passages cited above are read by all sides; the dispute is over which texts are normative and how to harmonize Rev 3:20, Matt 23:37 (Jerusalem unwilling), Acts 7:51 (you always resist the Holy Spirit), 1 Tim 2:4, 2 Pet 3:9, and the warning passages. Brethren-on-trial discipline: Plymouth Brethren are historically diverse on this (Darbyite high-Calvinist sovereignty; open-Brethren strands closer to Wesleyan or moderate). The user's formation may have pre-loaded the Reformed reading; that reading may be correct on the narrow proposition but the wider system is not a cult-marker line. Denying monergism (in the strict-Reformed sense) places one inside historic Christianity (Catholic, Orthodox, Wesleyan, Lutheran partial, Anglican-Arminian, Pentecostal), not outside it. Would-die-for is false because the gospel-stake (sinners saved by grace through faith in Christ alone) does not collapse on this in-house ordo-salutis question. Cult-marker-if-denied is false because Wesleyans, Catholics, Orthodox are not cults. Trusted-elder review should distinguish the lexical claim from the systematic package and not flatten an in-house Christian dispute into a gospel-stake. Stem audit: heavily Reformed-confessional wording ('monergistic work', 'sovereignly imparting', 'dead in sin', 'logically prior to and the cause of saving faith') pre-loads the verdict in Reformed terms; neutralized version below.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Regeneration (the new birth) is exclusively the work of the Holy Spirit acting upon a person spiritually unable to initiate it, and this work precedes and produces, rather than follows, saving faith.

Notes. The original stem stacks four Reformed-confessional terms in one sentence: 'monergistic work' (technical Reformed scholastic vocabulary), 'sovereignly imparting' (Westminster idiom), 'dead in sin' (Reformed-Pauline shorthand for total depravity), and 'logically prior to and the cause of saving faith' (Reformed ordo-salutis claim against Arminian-Catholic synergism). The confessional anchors named in the question are Westminster Confession 10 and Canons of Dort 3/4.11-12, both Reformed; no Catholic, Lutheran, Wesleyan, or Orthodox anchor appears. The question therefore pre-loads the Reformed reading as if neutral. The neutralized version above strips the technical labels and asks the substantive question: is the new birth God's sole act on a person unable to initiate it, and is it prior to faith. The neutral form can be answered from apparatus and interlinear without committing to the full Reformed system. Flag stem-pre-loaded-verdict added.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology, progressive_covenantalism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

Reformed-confessional ordo-salutis · affirms: regeneration is logically prior to faith and is the sole act of God in the elect; the universal-call passages refer to God's revealed will, the warning passages to apostasy from outward profession; *helkō* and *didōmi* are efficacious:

Wesleyan-Arminian prevenient grace · partially affirms: regeneration is the Spirit's work and is monergistic at its initiation as prevenient grace, but this grace is universally given and resistible; saving regeneration in the fullest sense follows the awakened will's yielding; *helkō* is universal drawing per John 12:32:

Roman Catholic sacramental synergism · partially affirms: prior gratuitous grace is monergistic in its initiation, the entire process of justification involves God's initiative plus free human response (CCC 2001 to 2002); regeneration is bestowed sacramentally at baptism and not chronologically tied to a conversion-faith:

Eastern Orthodox synergeia · partially denies: salvation throughout including regeneration is the cooperation of divine grace and human freedom; no act of the Spirit on the person bypasses the person's free response, though grace always has priority:

Lutheran Formula of Concord II · affirms with qualification: conversion is the work of the Holy Spirit alone, the unregenerate will contributes nothing, but Lutherans reject double predestination and hold that the regenerate can resist and fall; humans are passive in conversion and active in resisting:

The lexical pattern (passive verbs of new-birth, dead-resurrection imagery, absolute-inability statements) reads more naturally as monergistic on the narrow proposition. The complicating texts (real human refusals, universal divine willing-to-save, Matt 23:37) require harmonization either through (a) the Reformed two-wills distinction or (b) a prevenient-grace framework. The verdict honestly stands under reading (a), where it is the strongest reading; under (b) it is qualified rather than denied. Verdict therefore affirms on the strict-Reformed reading and the question is honestly contested across historic Christianity.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

John.1.13 · for · genre: gospel · figures: merism

Key term. οἱ οὐκ ἐξ αἱμάτων οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος σαρκὸς οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος ἀνδρὸς ἀλλ' ἐκ θεοῦ ἐγεννήθησαν; gennaō G1080 aorist passive indicative 3pl; thelēma G2307; anēr G435; theos G2316

Force. Triple explicit denial of human cause for the new birth (not from bloodlines, not from the will of the flesh, not from the will of a man), followed by the single divine cause (but of God they were born). The verb is aorist passive: subjects are patients of an action whose agent is God. Will of man is named and excluded as origin

John.3.3 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐὰν μή τις γεννηθῇ ἄνωθεν, οὐ δύναται ἰδεῖν τὴν βασιλείαν τοῦ θεοῦ; gennaō G1080 aorist passive subjunctive 3s; anōthen G509

Force. Categorical inability (ou dynatai) tied to a passive birth from above. Person is recipient of the birth; the divine agent is implicit

John.3.8 · for · genre: gospel · figures: simile

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμα ὅπου θέλει πνεῖ; pneuma G4151; thelō G2309; pneō G4154; gennaō G1080 perfect passive participle

Force. Spirit-wind blows where IT wills, not where the hearer wills. The hearer perceives the sound but does not control source or destination. Applied: so is everyone who has been born of the Spirit. The Spirit's sovereign initiative is the simile's whole point

John.6.44 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐδεὶς δύναται ἐλθεῖν πρὸς με ἐὰν μὴ ὁ πατὴρ...ἐλκύσῃ αὐτόν; helkō G1670 aorist active subjunctive 3s; dynamai G1410

Force. Absolute inability claim (no one is able) governed by ean mē (unless). The Father's drawing is the necessary condition of coming. Helkō in NT use elsewhere (drawing a net John 21:6, 11; dragging James 2:6, Acts 16:19) carries efficacious force, not mere invitation

John.6.65 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐδεὶς δύναται ἐλθεῖν πρὸς με ἐὰν μὴ ᾗ δεδομένον αὐτῷ ἐκ τοῦ πατρός; didōmi G1325 perfect passive participle

Force. Repeats the absolute inability with a different metaphor: the coming requires a prior, completed, perfect-tense grant from the Father. Coming is contingent on a divine giving that has already occurred

Eph.2.1 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. καὶ ὑμᾶς ὄντας νεκροὺς τοῖς παραπτώμασι καὶ ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις ὑμῶν; nekros G3498

Force. The pre-regenerate state is called dead, not sick or weakened. Dead persons cannot initiate their own resurrection. Sets up the divine-action contrast at v.4-5

Eph.2.5 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. καὶ ὄντας ἡμᾶς νεκροὺς τοῖς παραπτώμασι συνεζωοποίησεν τῷ Χριστῷ; suzōpoieō G4806 aorist active indicative 3s

Force. God is the subject of suzōpoieō: he made us alive together with Christ while we were still dead. The aorist active indicative places the action firmly on God's side; the human side is the dead patient. Logically the making-alive precedes any human cooperation, because the dead do not cooperate

Titus.3.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οὐκ ἐξ ἔργων τῶν ἐν δικαιοσύνῃ...ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὸ αὐτοῦ ἔλεος ἔσωσεν ἡμᾶς διὰ λουτροῦ παλιγγενεσίας καὶ ἀνακαινώσεως πνεύματος ἁγίου; palingenesia G3824; anakainōsis G342

Force. Negation of works-in-righteousness as basis, affirmation of his mercy as basis, of the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit as means. The agent throughout is God; the human is the saved recipient

1Pet.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ὁ κατὰ τὸ πολὺ αὐτοῦ ἔλεος ἀναγεννήσας ἡμᾶς εἰς ἐλπίδα ζώσαν; anagennaō G313 aorist active participle nominative masculine singular

Force. God the Father is the grammatical subject of the regenerating participle (the one who, according to his great mercy, regenerated us). Human believers are the direct object. The cause is his mercy, the act is his

Ezek.36.26 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: metaphor

Key term. נתת לי לב חד ורוח חדש יהוה נתת לי לב חד ורוח חדש; natan H5414 (I will give); sur H5493 (I will remove); leb H3820; ruach H7307

Force. Five first-person YHWH verbs in two verses (I will give, I will give, I will remove, I will give, I will put). The new heart and new spirit are entirely God's gift; the heart of stone is removed by God, not by the recipient. The covenant-renewal promise is unilateral

Acts.16.14 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. ἥς ὁ κύριος διήνοιξεν τὴν καρδίαν προσέχειν τοῖς λαλουμένοις ὑπὸ τοῦ Παύλου; dianoigō G1272 aorist active indicative 3s

Force. The Lord (kyrios) is the grammatical subject of dianoigō (opened); Lydia's heart is the direct object; her attending (prosechein) is the resultant infinitive of purpose or result. The heart-opening precedes and produces the attentive faith, not the other way around

1John.5.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων ὅτι Ἰησοῦς ἐστὶν ὁ Χριστὸς ἐκ τοῦ θεοῦ γεγέννηται; gennaō G1080 perfect passive indicative 3s; pisteuō G4100 present active participle

Force. The believing is in the present-tense participle (everyone who is now believing); the having-been-born-of-God is in the perfect tense (a past act with abiding present effect). Grammatically the past act of new birth grounds the present act of believing, supporting the order regeneration-then-faith

Rev.3.20 · complicates · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. ἰδοὺ ἔστηκα ἐπὶ τὴν θύραν καὶ κρούω· ἐάν τις ἀκούσῃ τῆς φωνῆς μου καὶ ἀνοίξῃ τὴν θύραν; krouō G2925; anoigō G455 aorist active subjunctive 3s

Force. Christ stands and knocks; the hearer is invited to open. The verb anoigō is active on the hearer's side. Synergistic readers cite this as a paradigm passage for divine invitation contingent on human opening. Reformed readers note the addressee is the Laodicean church (already covenant members), not the unregenerate, and that the Spirit's prior work enables the opening. The lexical pattern allows both readings

Matt.23.37 · complicates · genre: gospel · figures: personification

Key term. ποσάκις ἠθέλησα ἐπισυναγαγεῖν τὰ τέκνα σου...καὶ οὐκ ἠθελήσατε; thelō G2309 aorist active indicative 1s; ouk + thelō 2pl

Force. Jesus' I willed to gather, you did not will. The contrast names a divine desire frustrated by human unwillingness. Synergistic readers take this as evidence that grace is resistible at the corporate-Jerusalem level. Monergistic readers distinguish revealed-will from decreative-will and read the addressees as the unregenerate generation. The lexical pattern itself names a real refusal

Acts.7.51 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key term. ὑμεῖς ἀεὶ τῷ πνεύματι τῷ ἁγίῳ ἀντιπύπτετε; antiptō G496 present active indicative 2pl

Force. You always resist the Holy Spirit. Antiptō (fall against, resist) describes ongoing successful resistance to the Spirit by Stephen's audience. The verb's force is active human resistance, not passive non-cooperation. Synergistic readers cite this as canonical demonstration that the Spirit's drawing is resistible

1Tim.2.4 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. ὃς πάντας ἀνθρώπους θέλει σωθῆναι; thelō G2309 present active indicative 3s

Force. God who wills all people to be saved. The universalist scope of the divine willing complicates a strict monergistic reading in which only the elect are willed-to-be-saved. Reformed readers distinguish God's revealed will from his decreative will; the lexical text itself does not draw that distinction

2Pet.3.9 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. μὴ βουλόμενός τις ἀπολέσθαι ἀλλὰ πάντας εἰς μεάνοιαν χωρῆσαι; boulomai G1014 present middle participle

Force. Not wishing any to perish but all to come to repentance. Same complication as 1 Tim 2:4: the divine non-wishing-any-to-perish strains a reading in which the non-elect are decreed to perish

Josh.24.15 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key term. בַּחַרְוּ הַיּוֹם מִיָּהּ שֶׁתַּעֲבֹדוּ; bachar H977 imperative; abad H5647

Force. Choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve. A direct imperative addressed to the human will. Synergistic and Arminian readers take this as paradigmatic for a real, libertarian human choice in covenant response. Monergistic readers distinguish a national-covenant call from individual regeneration

Concordance lemmas traversed

G1080, G509, G4151, G313, G3824, G342, G4806, G3498, G1670, G1325, G1272, G2307, G2309, G496, G455, G2925, H5414, H5493, H3820, H7307, H2319, H977

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith chapter 10 (1647) · affirms · verified

“those whom God hath predestinated unto life...he is pleased in his appointed and accepted time, effectually to call by his Word and Spirit out of that state of sin and death”

reformed · Canons of Dort, Heads 3/4 articles 11-12 (1619) · affirms · verified

“regeneration is in no wise effected merely by the external preaching of the gospel, but is a supernatural, most powerful, and at the same time most delightful, astonishing, mysterious, and ineffable work”

lutheran · Formula of Concord, Solid Declaration, Article II Of Free Will · affirms · verified

“conversion to God is a work of God the Holy Ghost alone, who is the true Master that alone works this in us, for which the unregenerate will contributes nothing”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 1996 to 2002 · complicates · verified

“God's free initiative demands man's free response, for God has created man in his image by conferring on him, along with freedom, the power to know him and love him”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox doctrine of synergeia (collaboration of divine grace and human freedom in salvation; central distinctive across the Greek patristic and Byzantine tradition) · denies · unverified

“Salvation is the synergy of the Spirit and the human person; grace always precedes and enables, but never bypasses or overrides the free response of the will”

methodist · United Methodist Articles of Religion, Article 8 Of Free Will (Wesley's abridgement of the 39 Articles) · denies · verified

“we have no power to do good works...without the grace of God by Christ preventing us, that we may have a good will, and working with us, when we have that good will”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion, Article 10 Of Free Will (1571) · complicates · unverified

“we have no power to do good works pleasant and acceptable to God, without the grace of God by Christ preventing us, that we may have a good will, and working with us, when we have that good will”

patristic · Augustine of Hippo, anti-Pelagian writings (On Grace and Free Will, On the Predestination of the Saints, On the Gift of Perseverance, c. 426-429) · affirms · verified

“Augustine contends genuine grace requires not just knowledge of duty, but God's active co-operation and inspiration of love to enable human compliance; grace must be efficacious and prior”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Article 5 The Salvation of Man (Wesleyan-Arminian on this question) · denies · unverified

“Salvation is received through repentance toward God and faith in the Lord Jesus Christ; the response is enabled by prevenient grace, not by sovereign-effectual regeneration prior to faith”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/3.htm>

“gennēthē, aorist subjunctive passive: subject receives the action of being born rather than performing it; delegates agency away from human volition toward an external power”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/1.htm>

“triple denial in v.13: not of bloods, nor of will of flesh, nor of will of man; contrasted with ek theou egennēthēsan, of God they were born”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/2.htm>

“Humans: dead, passive, following worldly desires. God: active agent who made us alive together with Christ; renewal originates entirely from divine action”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/titus/3.htm>

“Greek ouk ex ergōn negates works-based salvation; alla kata to autou eleos pivots to mercy as basis; loutron palingenesias is the means, mercy is the basis”

nuance · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/john/6-44.htm>

“helkuō G1670 to drag, draw, pull; commentary tradition divides on whether the drawing is efficacious or invitation respecting human choice; lexical force is dragging”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/john/6-65.htm>

“didōmi perfect participle dedomenon indicates Father's grant precedes and enables human response; ean mē establishes absolute logical prerequisite for coming”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ezekiel/36.htm>

“YHWH is the exclusive agent: I will give, I will put, I will remove; cardiac and spiritual renewal entirely divinely sourced and executed”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/16.htm>

“The Lord is the grammatical subject of dianoigō active voice; Lydia is recipient of divine action; heart-opening attributed to divine initiative not human effort”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/1080.htm>

“John 1:13 ek theou egennēthēsan emphasizes spiritual birth independently of will of man; passive of gennao with divine agent across the johannine corpus”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/4806.htm>

“suzōopoieō two NT occurrences (Eph 2:5, Col 2:13); in both the actor is God who brings spiritual life to believers in conjunction with Christ”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/313.htm>

“anagennao two NT occurrences (1 Pet 1:3, 1:23); God is the active agent performing regeneration; believers are passive recipients”

opposes · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P6Z.HTM

“God's free initiative demands man's free response; God brings to completion in us what he has begun through our cooperative effort in justification and sanctification”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/solid-declaration/free-will/>

“conversion to God is a work of God the Holy Ghost alone, who is the true Master that alone works this in us; unregenerate will contributes nothing”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/npnf105.xv.iii.iii.html>

“Augustine: genuine grace requires not just knowledge of duty but God's active co-operation and inspiration of love; grace must be efficacious and prior to enable human response”

opposes · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“we have no power to do good works without the grace of God by Christ preventing us; prevenient grace initiates the process, human cooperation (working with us) is necessary”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- confession-tradition-divergence
- apparatus-paywalled